to. The best way to find out is generally to run your app and see whether you get flooded with uninteresting log messages.

TIP Most logging providers listen for configuration changes and update their filters dynamically. That means you should be able to modify your appsettings.json or appsettings.Development.json file and check the effect on the log messages, iterating quickly without restarting your app.

Even with your log verbosity under control, if you stick to the default logging providers like the file or console loggers, you'll probably regret it in the long run. These log providers work perfectly well, but when it comes to finding specific error messages or analyzing your logs, you'll have your work cut out for you. In the next section you'll see how structured logging can help you tackle this problem.

26.5 Structured logging: Creating searchable, useful logs

In this section you'll learn how structured logging makes working with log messages easier. You'll learn to attach key-value pairs to log messages and how to store and query for key values using the structured logging provider Seq. Finally, you'll learn how to use scopes to attach key-value pairs to all log messages within a block.

Let's imagine you've rolled out the recipe application we've been working on to production. You've added logging to the app so that you can keep track of any errors in your application, and you're storing the logs in a file.

One day, a customer calls and says they can't view their recipe. Sure enough, when you look through the log messages, you a see a warning: